Lesson 6

Linux Basic Commands

Introduction

- Linux commands are a set of commands that are used to interact with the Linux operating system.
- Linux commands are entered at the command prompt in a terminal window, and they allow users to perform a wide variety of tasks, such as managing files and directories, running processes, managing user accounts, and configuring network settings.
- This terminal is just like the command prompt of Windows OS.
- Linux commands are case-sensitive.
- The terminal can be used to accomplish all Administrative tasks.
- Execution of typed command is done only after you press the Enter key.

Basic Commands

Command	Description	Examples
ls	Lists files in a given directory	**ls /some/directory** **ls** # with no args, lists current dir **ls –a ,** Hidden files
cd	Change Working Directory	**cd /some/directory** **cd** #with no args, cd to home dir **cd..** ,used to go back from a folder to the folder before that **cd/** take you back to home directory
pwd	Print Working Directory	**pwd**
mkdir	Create New Directory	**mkdir subdirectory**
less	Display file one screen at a time	**less filename**

Basic Commands Cont'd…

Command	Description	Examples
cp	Copy files	**cp file1 newfile1** **cp file1 file2 file3 somedirectory**
mv	Move or rename a file	**mv oldfile newfile** **mv file1 file2 file3 somedirectory**
rm	Remove a file	**rm file1 file2** **rm -r dir** #removes all directories and subdirectories
rmdir	Remove a (empty) directory	**rmdir mydir**

Basic Commands Cont'd…

Command	Description	Examples
history	Display previously typed commands	**history**
grep	Find strings in files	**grep error file.out,** finds string "error" in the file named file.out **grep ^error file.out,** beginning of line **grep error^ file.out,** end of line
head	Show the first few lines of a file	**head myfile** **head -20 myfile**
tail	Show the last few lines of a file	**tail myfile** **tail -20 myfile**
file	Identify the type of a file	**file myfile**

Basic Commands Cont'd…

Command	Description	Examples
clear	Clear Screen	**clear,** This will clear all text and leave you with the $ prompt at the top of the window
wc	Word Count	**wc –w science.txt** **wc –l science.txt** count number of lines/words/characters in file
cat	concatenate	**cat file1 file2 file3 >myfiles** Used to join files to a new one
echo	Output text on the terminal.	**echo science.txt**
touch	Create an empty file	**touch myfile.txt**

Basic Commands Cont'd…

Command	**Description**	**Examples**
uname	display the operating system name	**uname**
lpr	To print a file	**lpr myfile.txt**
cmp	used to compare two files	**cmp file1.txt file2.txt**
echo $SHELL	Show you the shell you are working on.	**echo $SHELL**
cal	display a calendar of the current month	**cal**

Revision Questions

1. Give the commands which you will use to:
    i. Take you back to your home directory.
    ii. Show you the shell you are working on.
    iii. Explain to you the use of a command in Linux.
    iv. Show you the directory you are in.
2. Explain what the command **cat file1 file2 file3 >myfiles** do.
3. Give the command that will:
    i. Execute the last command in your history.
    ii. Display a calendar of the current month.